



Fedora 12—it's Constantine this time

Fedora 12, codenamed Constantine, has been released on November 17. New enhancements include next-generation Ogg Theora video, virtualisation improvements and advancements to NetworkManager, amongst numerous others.

The new Theora 1.1 enhances the quality of free video to better meet user expectations. Ogg Theora video in Fedora 12 delivers vibrant media, enabling users to stream and download high-definition video while using 100 per cent free and open software, codecs and formats. NetworkManager improvements in Fedora 12 make it easier for users to be online using mobile broadband, or configure servers. Virtualisation-related features include better virtual disk performance and storage discovery, hot changes for virtual network interfaces, reduced memory consumption and a modern network booting infrastructure.

You can get it from <http://get.fedoraproject.org> or wait for LFY's January 2010 issue to get a copy of the DVD.



Project Open 3.4 makes it simpler to implement ITIL

Project Open, a company founded by German engineers in Spain, has released version 3.4, which includes several new packages for the integrated management of IT operations. These new functionalities make it much simpler to implement ITIL and similar best practices, by covering a large percentage of ITIL processes with pre-defined and pre-configured functionality.

All new packages are integrated with project and financial management, making it possible to apply Activity Based Costing (ABC) and other control methods to IT operations. The new version includes: a helpdesk package that supports issue, problem and change management; a configuration database that supports configuration and licence management; a release management and a CVS integration package that support in-house software development, together with the standard PO project and portfolio management.

All packages are based on the PO configuration system, allowing users to add new attributes to objects and configure drop-down boxes. Workflows make it possible to control the life cycles of objects. Integrations are available with Active Directory/LDAP, Nagios, OCS Inventory NG, GanttProject and OpenProj. Integration with SAP and other back-end systems is available on request. Visit www.project-open.org/documentation/install_main for free download and installation instructions.

Firefox turns 5

Mozilla Firefox celebrated its fifth birthday on November 9. The most popular open source browser has achieved many milestones and promises to offer more in the next five years. On November 9, 2004, Mozilla Foundation launched

Firefox 1.0 with the belief that, as the most significant social and technological development of our time, the Internet is a public resource that must remain open and accessible to all.

Within the first four days of Firefox's launch, more than 1 million people had downloaded a brand new browsing experience. In just five years, that number has swelled to over 330 million users worldwide;

almost a quarter of Internet users worldwide use Firefox. Today, Firefox ships in more than 70 languages and offers users more than 7,000 add-ons to help customise their browsing experience.



Event addresses the role of information security

Information security is an integral part of the software development life cycle and needs to be included at every stage. This was the advice conveyed by Securitybyte and OWASP AppSec Asia 2009, an information security event organised in Gurgaon from November 17-20, 2009. Speaking at the sidelines of the conference, Dhruv Soi, chair, OWASP India and partner, Securitybyte, said, "While IT is a dominant sector in India, for millions of developers and IT professionals, information security is still an enigma and area best left to experts." The most interesting talk on open source security was on exploiting Mozilla Firefox extensions. Roberto Suggi Liverani and Nick Freeman, security consultants with security-assessment.com, offered insights into the substantial danger posed by Firefox extensions.